Sprint 3 - Team 11

Competitive landscape

Three competitors, one for each type, and the reasons people might switch. Evidence IDs (E-01 to E-06) refer to our evidence log.

Map

	Direct	Indirect	Status quo
Competitor profiled	Wanderlog	Google Maps	Manual multi-app habit (TikTok, Instagram, Maps, booking sites, AI)
Job it does for the user	Plan a multiday trip with an itinerary and budget	Find places and work out travel between them	Pick a place, find things to do, book, and keep track by hand
Assumption we tested	There is flight data available. Supported: Wanderlog has a booking step (E-04).	Travelers need a way to organize places they want to visit. Partly contradicted: Maps already saves lists (E-05).	People plan across several apps and lose time to it. Partly supported: all three interviewees used several tools, but losing time was not recorded (E-01 to E-03).
Named by interviewees	0 of 3	1 of 3 (P2)	3 of 3
Evidence	E-04	E-05, E-02	E-06, E-01, E-02, E-03

Also named by interviewees (not torn down). Types are our best classification.

Competitor	Type	Used by	What we saw
AI assistants (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini)	Indirect	P1, P2	P1 pays about $20/month and said AI saves time. P2 used ChatGPT. The only competitor with a price in our evidence. (E-01, E-02)
TikTok	Indirect (discovery habit)	P1, P2	Used to find attractions and locations. (E-01, E-02)
Instagram	Indirect (discovery habit)	P2, P3	P3 found her event there and followed it there. P2 finds it hard to search. (E-02, E-03)
Expedia, Booking.com, Priceline	Indirect	P1, P3	Used for hotels and flights. P1 had trouble getting help from third parties. (E-01, E-03)
Hilton (direct booking)	Indirect	P1	Booked through Hilton, tied to a credit card. (E-01)
Airbnb	Indirect	P3	Skipped it for a 2-day trip; a hotel seemed cheaper. (E-03)

Side by side

	Wanderlog (direct)	Google Maps (indirect)	Status quo (manual multi-app)
Core job tested	Plan a multiday trip with an itinerary and budget	Find places and compare travel time between them	Plan a trip across several apps
Time in teardown	About 40 min, hands-on	About 30 min, hands-on	About 30 min, estimated, built from interviews
Price (consumer)	Free tier; Pro $39.99/year (claim)	Free for the main features	Free tools; about $20/month for AI (P1)
Business model	Subscriptions (claim)	Businesses and developers pay for Maps Platform (claim)	Mix of free social apps, booking sites and optional AI subscriptions
Main flow	Sign up, trip dates and location, explore, booking step, itinerary, budget	Sign in, search, browse reviews, save to a list, check directions, review the list	Pick a place from a social post, find activities, check Maps reviews, book on a booking site or direct
Day-by-day itinerary	Yes, built by hand day by day	No automatic day-by-day	No single place for it
Budget tracking	A budget tool exists; unclear how it ties to the itinerary	No total budget calculated	Budgeting not mentioned by interviewees
Booking	Booking step for hotels, flights and cars	No	Separate booking sites or direct (E-01, E-03)
Collaboration	Can invite others to a trip	Shared lists others can edit (claim); P2 says Maps is easy to share	Not recorded
AI assistance	AI assistant, seemed capped at 10 messages	None noted	ChatGPT, Claude or Gemini (P1, P2)
What works well	Full planning without Pro; invite others; explore nearby	Quick search; easy saving; directions and map view	Free and familiar; TikTok is easy to search (P2); AI saves time (P1)
Pain points and limits	Offline mode and AI cap tied to Pro (claim); unclear budget tool	No budget, no itinerary; moving between views; many results	Scattered tools; little help from booking sites (P1); Instagram hard to search (P2)
Where we may beat it (team hypothesis, not tested with users)	Event-based destination discovery	Total budget, affordability, day-by-day itinerary	One place for discovery, itinerary and budget
Evidence	E-04	E-05	E-06, E-01, E-02, E-03

Why people might switch

Ranked by how much recorded evidence supports each. Every trigger rests on one or two of three interviewees, so treat the ranks as hypotheses.

#	Trigger	Force	Evidence	Behavior or opinion	Heard from	Strength and caveat
1	A trip is coming up and the person has no help planning it	Push	E-03	Behavior (planned right after finding the event) and opinion (needs a planner)	1 of 3	Strongest stated need, but one person. Tied to an event, which fits our event idea.
2	Saving time	Pull (toward AI, the bar to beat)	E-01	Opinion (saves time) and behavior (pays about $20/month)	1 of 3 (P2 also used ChatGPT)	Shows what a new tool is up against. Paid behavior is the most solid part.
3	Keeping costs down	Push / anxiety	E-01, E-03	Behavior (flights chosen by price) and opinion (hotel cheaper than Airbnb)	2 of 3	Price drives choices, but nobody described tracking or overspending a budget.
4	Getting help when something goes wrong	Push	E-01	Behavior (could not cancel, little help with errors) and opinion ("Direct is better")	1 of 3	Concrete, but one person.
5	Fewer apps for one trip	Push (inferred)	E-01, E-02, E-03	Behavior (2+ tools: 3 of 3; 3+ tools: 2 of 3)	3 of 3 behavior, 0 complaints	Nobody called this a problem. A hypothesis until someone does.

What holds people in place

Force	Type	Evidence	Behavior or opinion	Heard from	Note
TikTok and Instagram are where people discover places and events	Habit	E-01, E-02, E-03	Behavior	3 of 3	P3 followed event information on Instagram because organizers post there.
Familiar, free tools	Habit	E-02	Opinion (TikTok familiar and easy)	1 of 3	P2 spent nothing on planning.
Existing loyalty and payment arrangements	Habit	E-01, E-03	Behavior (Hilton credit card; asked dad for points)	2 of 3	Booking choices are tied to cards and points.
AI subscription already paid for	Habit	E-01	Behavior ($20/month)	1 of 3	Said nothing would stop him from using AI (hypothetical).